CA/Browser Forum Tracker

What Changed, 18 to 25 October 2026

Last updated: 2026-10-25

About This Report

This is an experimental, AI-driven research project from SRL. SRL is independent, with no outside funding and no sponsors. This tracker is a summarized pull of the public record, kept as a coherent, concise news update. It draws on the CA/Browser Forum's own ballots, mailing lists and published documents, and on the public sources of the browser root programs. An AI model reads those sources and writes the summary, and every statement links to the source it came from. Where two sources disagree, both are reported. AI makes mistakes, so check the linked source before relying on any statement. The tracker is updated each week that the public record shows a change.

This update covers the CA/Browser Forum and the browser root programs from 18 October to 25 October 2026. It follows the 18 October update. The period is seven days long, and the report covers only what moved.

Section 1 names the change that matters most. Section 2 follows the Forum's ballots, two of which changed stage. Section 3 covers the root programs and the incident record. Section 4 covers transparency logs and the standards underneath. Section 5 closes with the picture as it stood on 18 October.

1. What Matters Most

A certificate authority generated eight intermediate keys so badly that anyone could recover them, and within three days one of its roots was out of two browser root stores.

On Saturday 17 October a security researcher told Chrome that the private keys of eight eMudhra intermediate authorities could be recovered [1]. Six issue website certificates and two issue code signing certificates trusted by Microsoft [1]. The keys came from a ceremony on 30 April 2025, and their private scalars were smaller than 256 [1]. Chrome described the cause as "insufficient randomness" [2].

The response was measured in hours. Chrome received the report at 18:05 UTC and blocked the keys through its revocation list at 19:45 UTC [2]. Mozilla received it at 20:06 UTC, recovered the keys itself, and had its own block fully distributed by 22:59 UTC [1] [3]. eMudhra revoked the eight certificates the next morning, saying "human errors in multiple steps" were to blame, and admitting that its revocation lists had been re-signed with the flawed keys [1].

Then came the removals. On 20 October Mozilla ordered "the emergency removal of trust in emSign ECC Root CA - G3", the root that signed the eight [1]. NSS 3.131.1 and Firefox 158.0.1 shipped the same day with that root gone [3] [4]. Chrome removes the same root in its root store update of 27 October, and said it "confirmed that no other keys included in our root stores share the same failure mode" [2]. About 30,000 certificates chain to that root, almost all issued through ACME [5].

Chrome is also “closely investigating the ongoing inclusion of eMudhra’s remaining CA certificates” [2]. On 21 October it posted twelve questions, and on 23 October it rejected public scrutiny as a reason for delay [5]. Early on 25 October eMudhra’s representative wrote that the company “has decided to exit public TLS” [5]. A reply thirty minutes later counted 107,107 certificates logged under the revoked keys as proofs of concept, and reported that eMudhra’s status servers refuse common tooling [5]. Cloudflare closed three of its transparency logs to new submissions on 20 October to stop that flood [6].

2. The Forum’s Ballots

A ballot passes through discussion, a seven-day vote, a thirty-day intellectual property review and publication, and only the last step makes it a rule.

Recent Developments

SMC020 passed. The ballot removes the requirement to record which version of the S/MIME rules a validation method came from, and adds audit log fields from March 2027 [7]. All sixteen voting certificate issuers and all three consumers, Apple, Mozilla and rundQuadrat, voted in favour on 20 October [7]. Its intellectual property review runs until 19 November, and the attached redline is labelled version 1.0.17 [7].

SC105 moved to a vote. The ballot removes the High Risk Certificate Request language from the Baseline Requirements and the Extended Validation Guidelines [8]. Voting opened on 21 October at 16:00 UTC and closes on 28 October [8]. Four votes in favour were readable by 22 October, from TWCA, Kamu SM, DigiCert and OISTE, with none against [8] [9].

The post-quantum ballot lost its draft. On 21 October the author of SC-106 closed the pull request that carried it, unmerged [10]. The closing note records that Chrome, Mozilla and Cloudflare want to drop the rule that a post-quantum authority may sign only post-quantum certificates [10]. It says the profile will be proposed in a future working group for consumers other than browsers [10]. The group’s agenda for 22 October still lists the ballot as a draft that Amazon Trust Services is taking over, with an update expected [11].

Two new drafts appeared without ballot numbers. One, from 20 October, clarifies the country name field [11]. The other, from 22 October, would reject ECDSA private scalars smaller than 256 from 15 January 2027, and names the eMudhra compromise as its motive [12]. Its author asked the list for endorsers [12].

Current State

CSC-034 has closed its vote without a result. Voting on the code signing ballot ended on 21 October at 17:00 UTC [13]. By then HARICA, eMudhra, Certum, Sectigo, Actalis, Microsoft and SHECA had voted in favour, and no one against [13]. No results post had appeared by 25 October, so the ballot stays in its voting stage until the chair reports [13].

SC-107, on certificate problem reports, is still in discussion with no post since 15 October and no vote called [14]. NS-010 version 2 remains in intellectual property review until 13 November, and the network security group’s page still lists it as voting [15]. The Baseline Requirements stay at version 2.3.1.

The server certificate group published the minutes of its September face-to-face meeting on 23 October [16]. They record four ballots under consideration, a proposal to issue formal revisions only once or twice a year, and 74 open issues [16]. They also record that Huawei was approved as a certificate consumer member with no objections [16]. The group's 22 October call deferred the face-to-face topics and set its next call for 4 November [11].

One public objection reached the group. An IT director at an electrical contractor wrote on 22 October that the schedule of validity reductions is unsustainable, and the chair forwarded it for consideration [17]. A reply noted that the 47-day maximum does not apply until March 2029, and asked for an assessment of operational impact [17].

3. Root Programs and Incidents

The root programs decide who is trusted, and their public bug tracker is where every failure to follow the rules is recorded.

Recent Developments

GoDaddy finished its mass revocation four days late. By the deadline of 18 October at 23:45 UTC it had revoked 170,566 certificates, and by early on 19 October 227,422 [18]. On 22 October at 22:50 UTC it reported the work complete [18]. The corrected total was 403,643 certificates, of which 378,067 were revoked and 25,576 had expired, leaving none valid [18]. No root program has commented on either GoDaddy bug, and the full incident report is still outstanding [18].

Thirty-three compliance bugs opened between 18 and 25 October [19]. TrustAsia reported 19,237 certificates issued against a domain owner's authorization records, all revoked [19]. SHECA reported status responder keys with a public exponent of three, which HARICA called practically unrevocable, and SHECA revoked every authority under four roots that browsers do not trust [20]. DigiCert reported a revocation list published three minutes late and is moving its schedule to twenty hours [21].

Two authorities reported lists whose validity ran one second long, and seven bugs in one week concern status responder profiles, which looks like one third party's sweep [19]. Sectigo filed two reports against the network security requirements, and IdenTrust reported two subordinate authorities that stray from its own profile while its inclusion is under discussion [19]. D-Trust reported the loss of archived email registration records at a customer [19].

Current State

The eMudhra removals are the only trust actions of the period. No other root program policy text changed, and Apple's draft Merkle Tree Certificate policy, promised by the end of October, has still not appeared [22]. Chrome's promised update on eMudhra's remaining roots had not reached the CCADB public list by 25 October [5].

4. Transparency and Standards

Every public certificate must appear in transparency logs whose operators are held to a standard, and the Forum's documents cite IETF standards that are still settling.

Recent Developments

Chrome’s log list reached version 95.11 on 24 October with no change to any log’s state [23]. Let’s Encrypt reported that three of its logs served stale checkpoints during six short instance replacements on 19 and 20 October [24]. One replacement deployed the log software that blocks the eMudhra keys [24]. The Chrome transparency team said on 21 October that its policy had been violated [24]. The log software’s author replied that one-minute merge delays “are simply a mistake” and proposed a 24-hour limit with a stricter freshness rule [24].

TrustAsia hard-coded its block size in response to the earlier complaint, and said on 24 October that it will run no logs of the original design after its 2027 shards [25].

Current State

The composite signature draft, which pairs ML-DSA with a conventional algorithm in one certificate, moved on 19 October to a blocked state awaiting final approval, and still has no RFC number [26]. The certificate request attestation draft reached its 32nd revision and goes before the steering group on 5 November [27]. The TLS working group adopted a composite ML-DSA draft on 23 October [28].

5. Where Things Stood on 18 October

The 18 October update told the longer story, and this section recalls enough of it to read this one.

On 18 October GoDaddy had just admitted it would miss the deadline for revoking 404,607 certificates whose policy information did not match its practice statement. No ballot had changed stage in three days. SMC020 and CSC-034 were in their votes, SC105 was in discussion, and SC-107 was already overdue.

Ten compliance bugs had opened in two days, four of them about late audit statements. Chrome had moved its quantum-resistant testing programme to a newer draft, and Apple’s draft Merkle Tree Certificate policy was awaited. Chrome’s log list stood at version 95.3, and the composite signature draft was in final review.

Sources

1. Bug 2083449, eMudhra intermediate CA private key compromise - Mozilla Bugzilla - https://bugzilla.mozilla.org/show_bug.cgi?id=2083449 - as of 2026-10-25
2. Protecting Chrome and Android users from compromised eMudhra intermediate CA certificates - Google Security Blog - https://blog.google/security/protecting-chrome-and-android-users-from-compromised-emudhra-intermediate-ca-certificates/ - as of 2026-10-25
3. Protecting Firefox users following the compromise of eMudhra intermediate certificates - Mozilla Security Blog - https://blog.mozilla.org/security/2026/10/20/protecting-firefox-users-following-the-compromise-of-emudhra-intermediate-certificates/ - as of 2026-10-25

4. NSS 3.131.1 release notes - Mozilla - https://firefox-source-docs.mozilla.org/security/nss/releases/nss_3_131_1.html - as of 2026-10-25
5. eMudhra compromised intermediate CA private keys - mozilla dev-security-policy - https://groups.google.com/a/mozilla.org/g/dev-security-policy/c/0R3XLJL6FuE - as of 2026-10-25
6. Raio RFC 6962 log shards closed to submissions - chromium ct-policy list - https://groups.google.com/a/chromium.org/g/ct-policy/c/Xr0OqtDQplQ - as of 2026-10-25
7. Ballot SMC-020, Remove requirement to record BR version of validation method, results - CA/Browser Forum - https://cabforum.org/2026/10/05/ballot-smc-020/ - as of 2026-10-25
8. Ballot SC105, Remove High Risk language from TLS BR and EVG, discussion and voting thread - servercert-wg list - https://groups.google.com/a/groups.cabforum.org/g/servercert-wg/c/sh5xhEQUCvg - as of 2026-10-25
9. Final agenda, Server Certificate Working Group teleconference of 22 October 2026 - servercert-wg list - https://groups.google.com/a/groups.cabforum.org/g/servercert-wg/c/OlQGYqiVOJM - as of 2026-10-25
10. Pull request 679 timeline, SC-106 ML-DSA - cabforum/servercert - https://api.github.com/repos/cabforum/servercert/issues/679/timeline?per_page=100 - as of 2026-10-25
11. Draft agenda, Server Certificate Working Group teleconference of 22 October 2026 - servercert-wg list - https://groups.google.com/a/groups.cabforum.org/g/servercert-wg/c/1h3qWT99Rt8 - as of 2026-10-25
12. Draft ballot on key quality checking and ECDSA small private scalars - servercert-wg list - https://groups.google.com/a/groups.cabforum.org/g/servercert-wg/c/KvmAHsXJveM - as of 2026-10-25
13. Ballot CSC-034 voting period - cscwg-public list - https://groups.google.com/a/groups.cabforum.org/g/cscwg-public/c/OnTH2Kbm-l0 - as of 2026-10-25
14. Ballot SC-107 threads - servercert-wg list - https://groups.google.com/a/groups.cabforum.org/g/servercert-wg/search?q=SC-107 - as of 2026-10-25
15. Network Security Working Group ballots - CA/Browser Forum - https://cabforum.org/working-groups/netsec/ballots/ - as of 2026-10-25
16. Minutes of the F2F 68 meeting in Vienna, Server Certificate Working Group, 23 September 2026 - CA/Browser Forum - https://cabforum.org/2026/09/23/minutes-of-the-f2f-68-meeting-in-vienna-austria-scwg-september-23-2026/ - as of 2026-10-25
17. Formal objection to Ballot SC-081v3 - servercert-wg list - https://groups.google.com/a/groups.cabforum.org/g/servercert-wg/c/ZEZJE_GDFeE - as of 2026-10-25
18. Bug 2083191, GoDaddy delayed revocation - Mozilla Bugzilla - https://bugzilla.mozilla.org/show_bug.cgi?id=2083191 - as of 2026-10-25

19. CA Certificate Compliance bugs opened from 17 October 2026 - Mozilla Bugzilla - https://bugzilla.mozilla.org/rest/bug?product=CA%20Program&component=CA%20Certificate%20Compliance&creation_time=2026-10-17&include_fields=id,summary,creation_time,status,whiteboard,creator - as of 2026-10-25
20. Bug 2084097, SHECA OCSP responder keys with public exponent 3 - Mozilla Bugzilla - https://bugzilla.mozilla.org/show_bug.cgi?id=2084097 - as of 2026-10-25
21. Bug 2083502, DigiCert CRL number decreasing and late CRL publication - Mozilla Bugzilla - https://bugzilla.mozilla.org/show_bug.cgi?id=2083502 - as of 2026-10-25
22. Apple Root Program policy repository tree - GitHub - https://api.github.com/repos/apple/apple-root-program/git/trees/main?recursive=1 - as of 2026-10-25
23. Chrome Certificate Transparency log list, v3 - Google - https://www.gstatic.com/ct/log_list/v3/log_list.json - as of 2026-10-25
24. Let’s Encrypt Twig, Sycamore and Willow stale checkpoints - chromium ct-policy list - https://groups.google.com/a/chromium.org/g/ct-policy/c/fEm84uwtg9Y - as of 2026-10-25
25. TrustAsia log get-entries limits - chromium ct-policy list - https://groups.google.com/a/chromium.org/g/ct-policy/c/glxX0b492wE - as of 2026-10-25
26. draft-ietf-lamps-pq-composite-sigs, history - IETF Datatracker - https://datatracker.ietf.org/doc/draft-ietf-lamps-pq-composite-sigs/history/ - as of 2026-10-25
27. draft-ietf-lamps-csr-attestation, history - IETF Datatracker - https://datatracker.ietf.org/doc/draft-ietf-lamps-csr-attestation/history/ - as of 2026-10-25
28. draft-ietf-tls-composite-mldsa - IETF Datatracker - https://datatracker.ietf.org/doc/draft-ietf-tls-composite-mldsa/ - as of 2026-10-25